who will not even permit independent labour unions to exist in their domains. The fact that a majority of the people affected desires the change is not considered enough, the very people who stand to lose by it should be converted. Thus a few interested parties can hold up an obviously desirable change.

If there is one thing that history shows it is this: that economic interests shape the political views of groups and classes. Neither reason nor moral considerations override these interests. Individuals may be converted, they may surrender their special privileges, although this is rare enough, but classes and groups do not do so. The attempt to convert a governing and privileged class into forsaking power and giving up its unjust privileges has therefore always so far failed, and there seems to be no reason whatever to hold that it will succeed in the future. Reinhold Niebuhr in his book [1] directs his argument against the moralists "who imagine that the egoism of individuals is being progressively checked by the development of rationality or the growth of a religiously inspired goodwill, and that nothing but the continuance of this process is necessary to establish social harmony between all the human societies and collectives." These moralists "'disregard the political necessities in the struggle for justice in human society by failing to recognise those elements in man's collective behaviour which belong to the order of nature and can never be brought completely under the dominion of reason or conscience. They do not recognise that when collective power, whether in the form of imperialism or class domination, exploits weakness, it can never be dislodged unless power is raised against it." And again: "Since reason is always, to some degree, the servant of interest in a social situation, social justice cannot be resolved by moral or rational suasion alone.... Conflict is inevitable, and in this conflict power must be challenged by power."

To think, therefore, in terms of pure conversion of a class or nation or of the removal of conflict by rational argument and appeals to justice, is to delude oneself. It is an illusion to imagine that a dominant imperialist Power will give up its domination over a country, or that a class will give up its superior position and privileges unless effective pressure, amounting to coercion, is exercised.

Gandhiji obviously wants to apply that pressure, though he does not call it coercion. According to him, his method is self-suffering. It is a little difficult to consider this, as there is a

[1] *Moral Man and Immoral Society.*